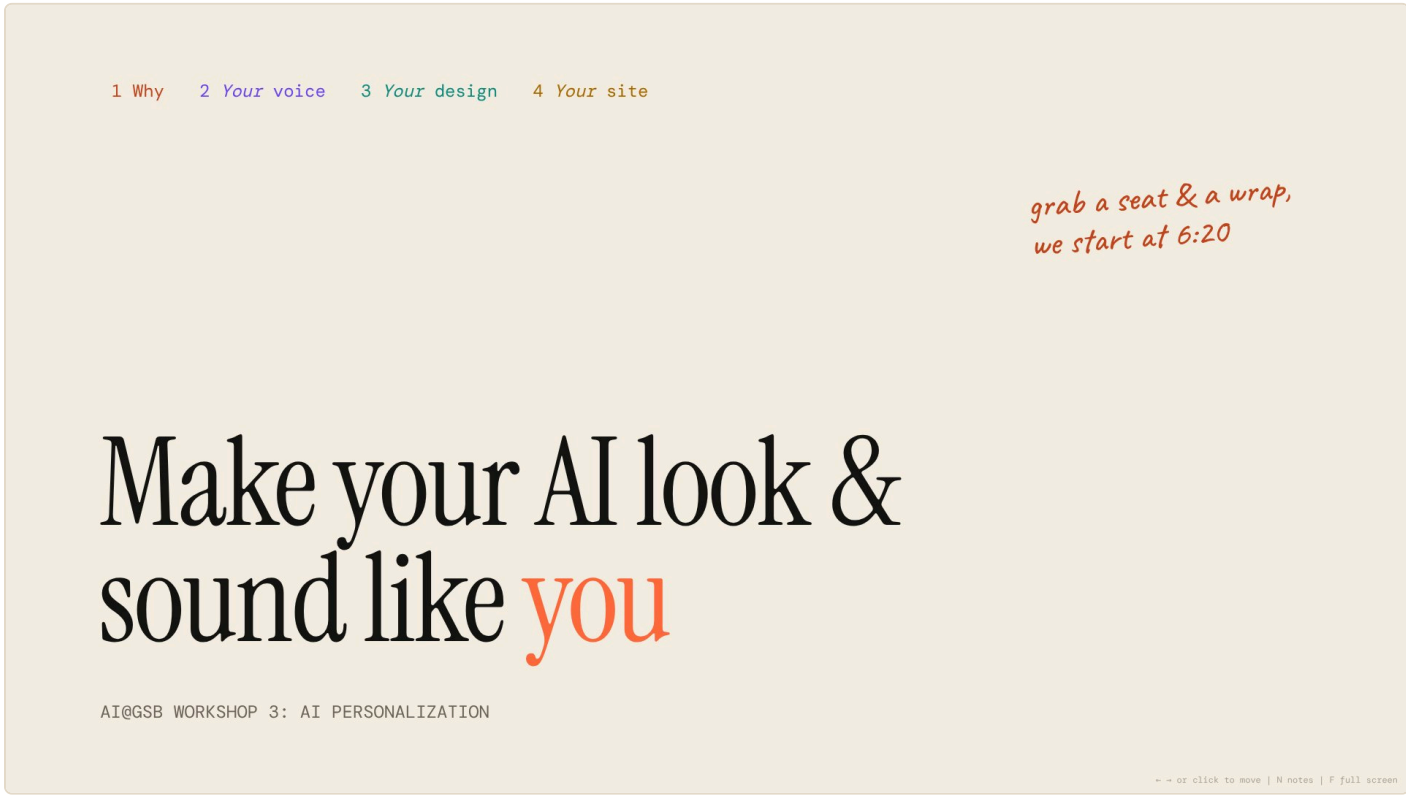
Workshop 3: AI that feels like you

Slides + talking points, final

AI@GSB, Mary Blankemeier

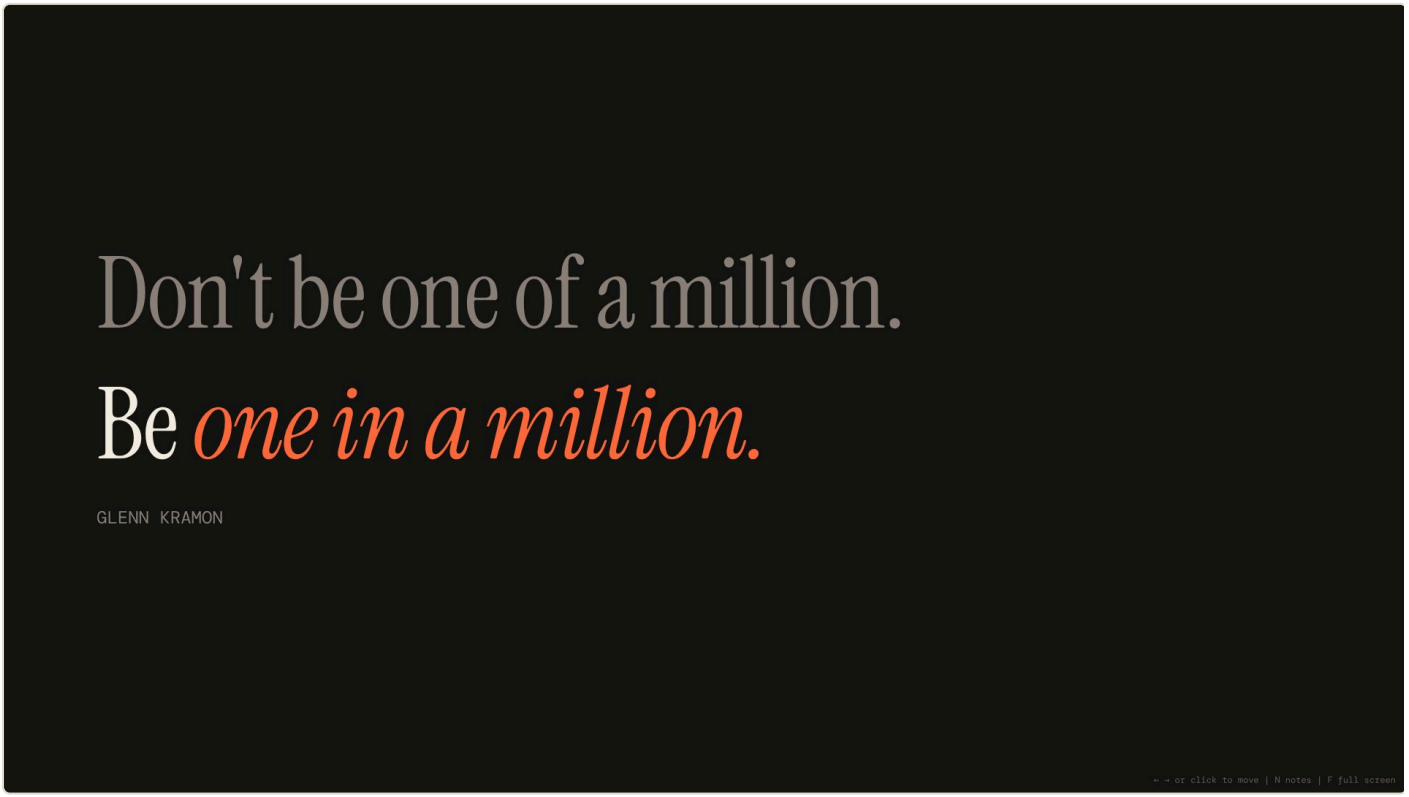
Each page: the slide fully built, then the key points to hit.

01 WALKIN



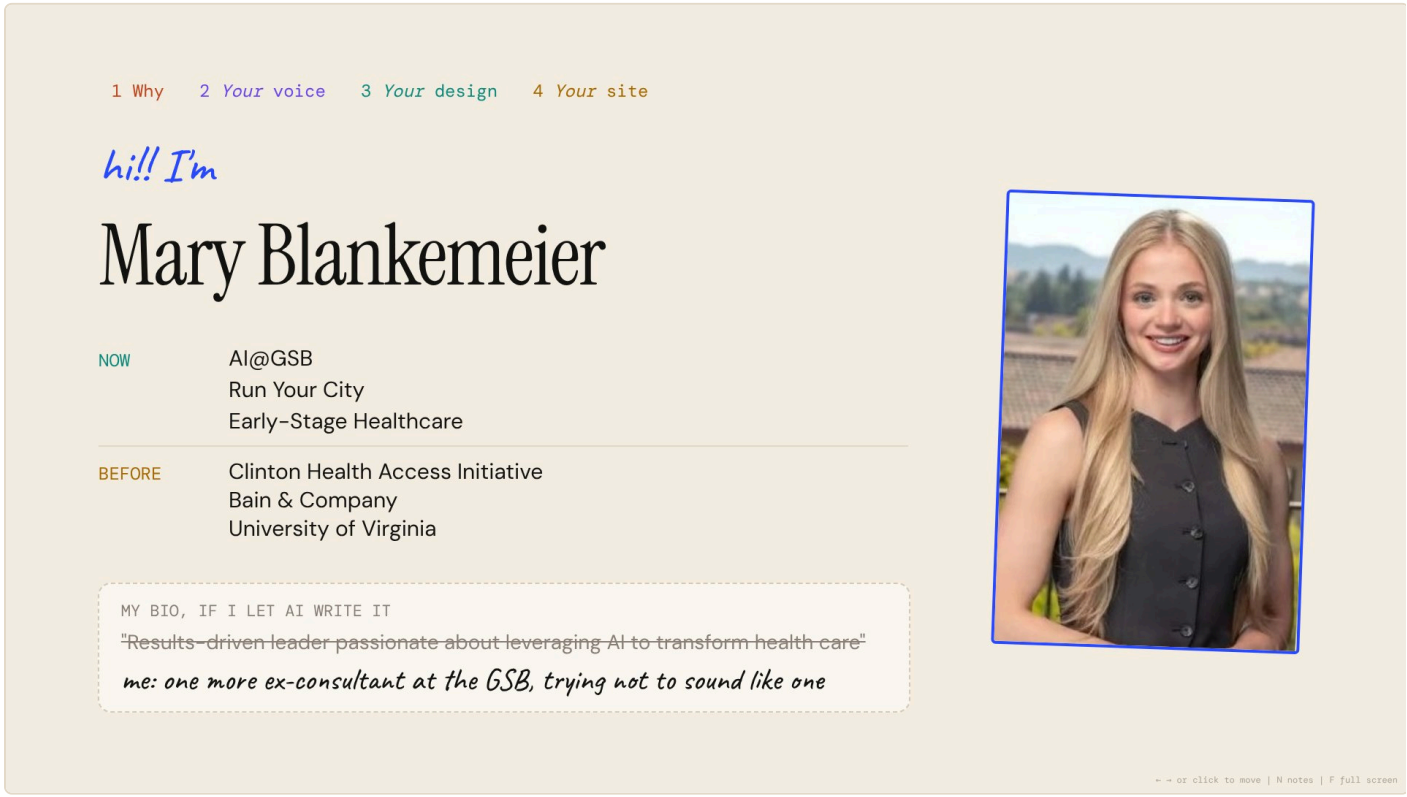
- Sign in to Claude now so you're ready when we build.
- We start at 6:20.

02 QUOTE



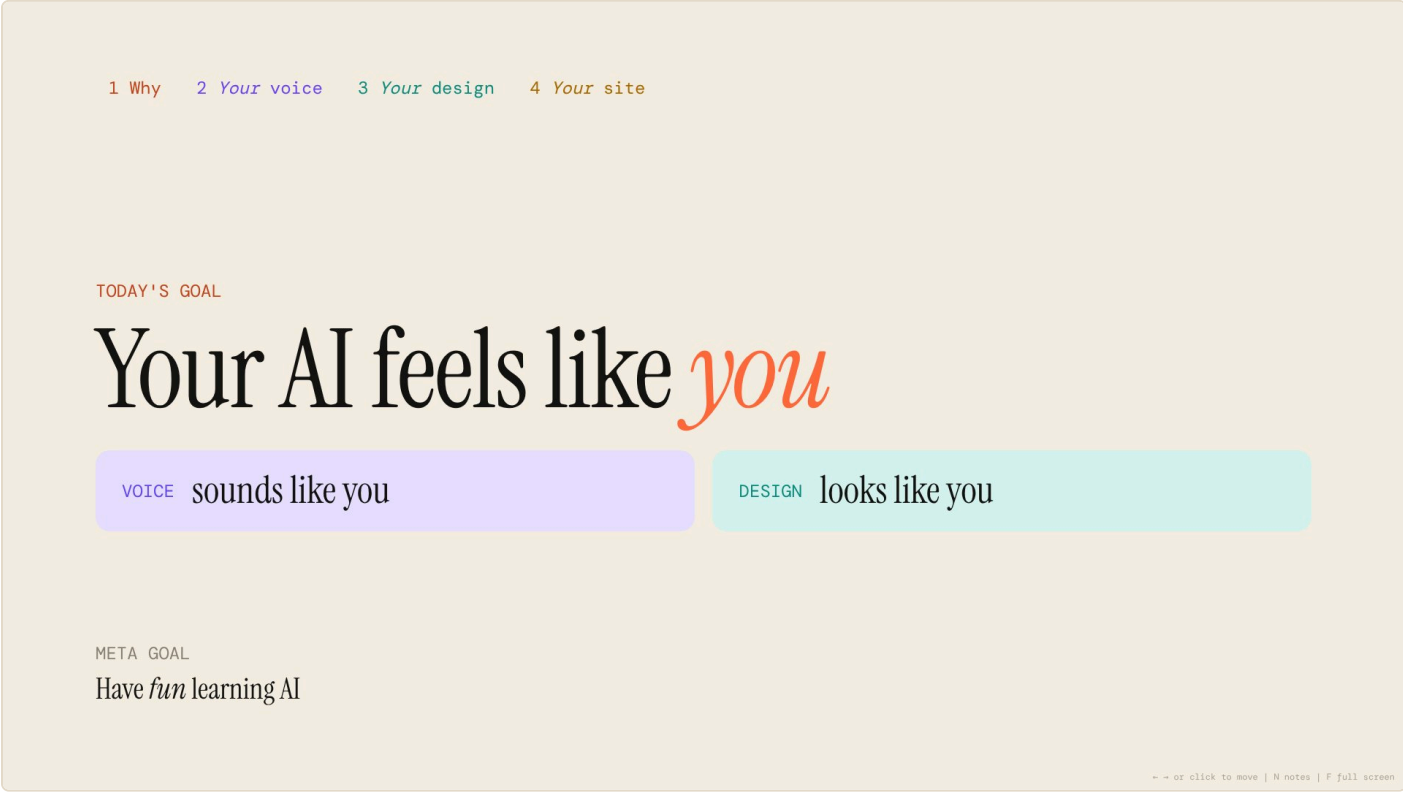
- Glenn Kramon's line from Winning Writing.
- Left alone, AI gives everyone the same bio, the same site, the same email.
- Tonight is about making it sound and look like you.

03 HI



- Mary, MBA2, AI@GSB Fellow. Now: AI@GSB, Run Your City, early-stage healthcare.
- Before: Clinton Health Access Initiative, Bain. Yes, one more ex-consultant at the GSB.
- Read the AI bio in your best LinkedIn voice. It could be anyone in this room.
- That's tonight: AI that sounds like you, not like everyone.

04 GOAL

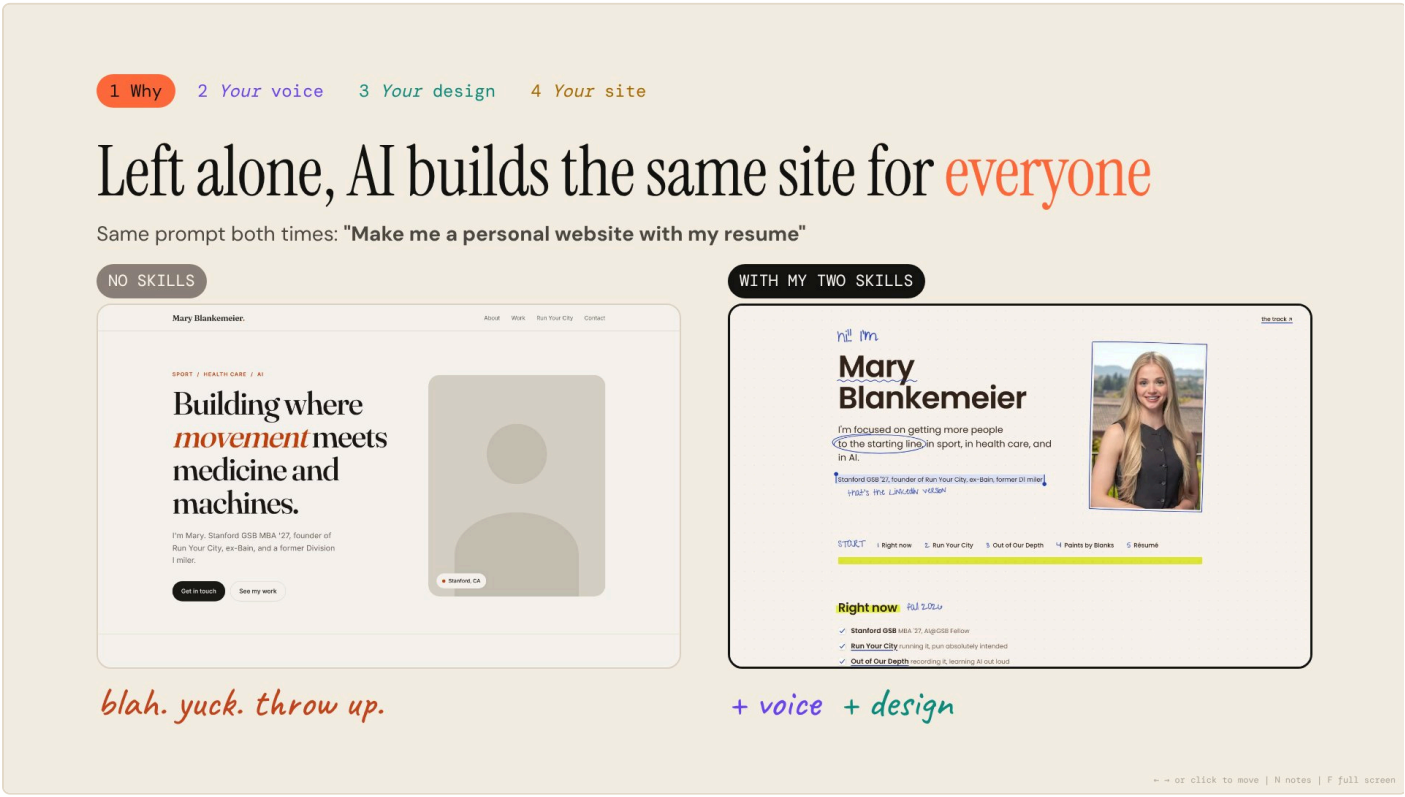


- Goal: AI that feels like you. The voice skill handles how it sounds, the design skill how it looks.
- Meta goal: have fun learning AI. If it's fun, you'll keep using it.

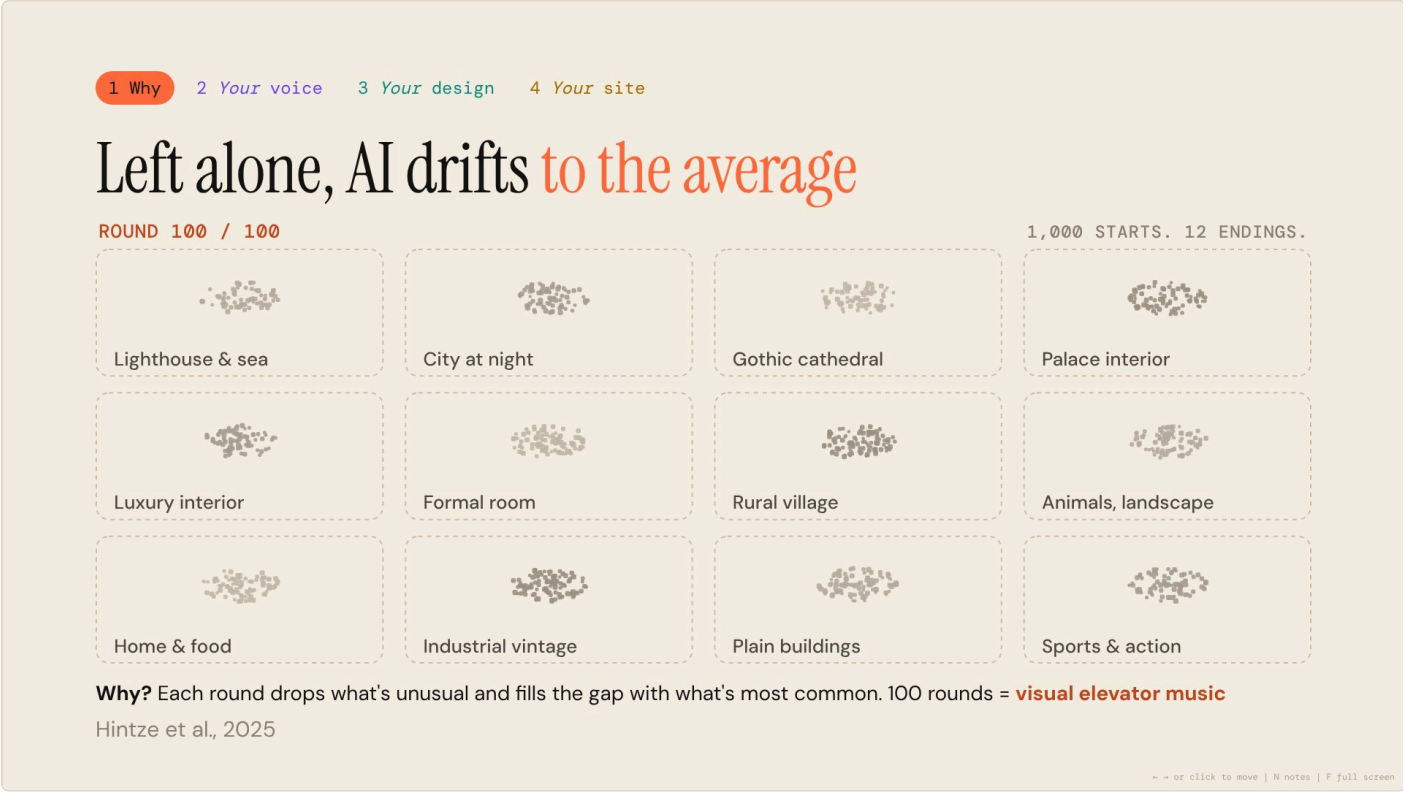
05 TONIGHT



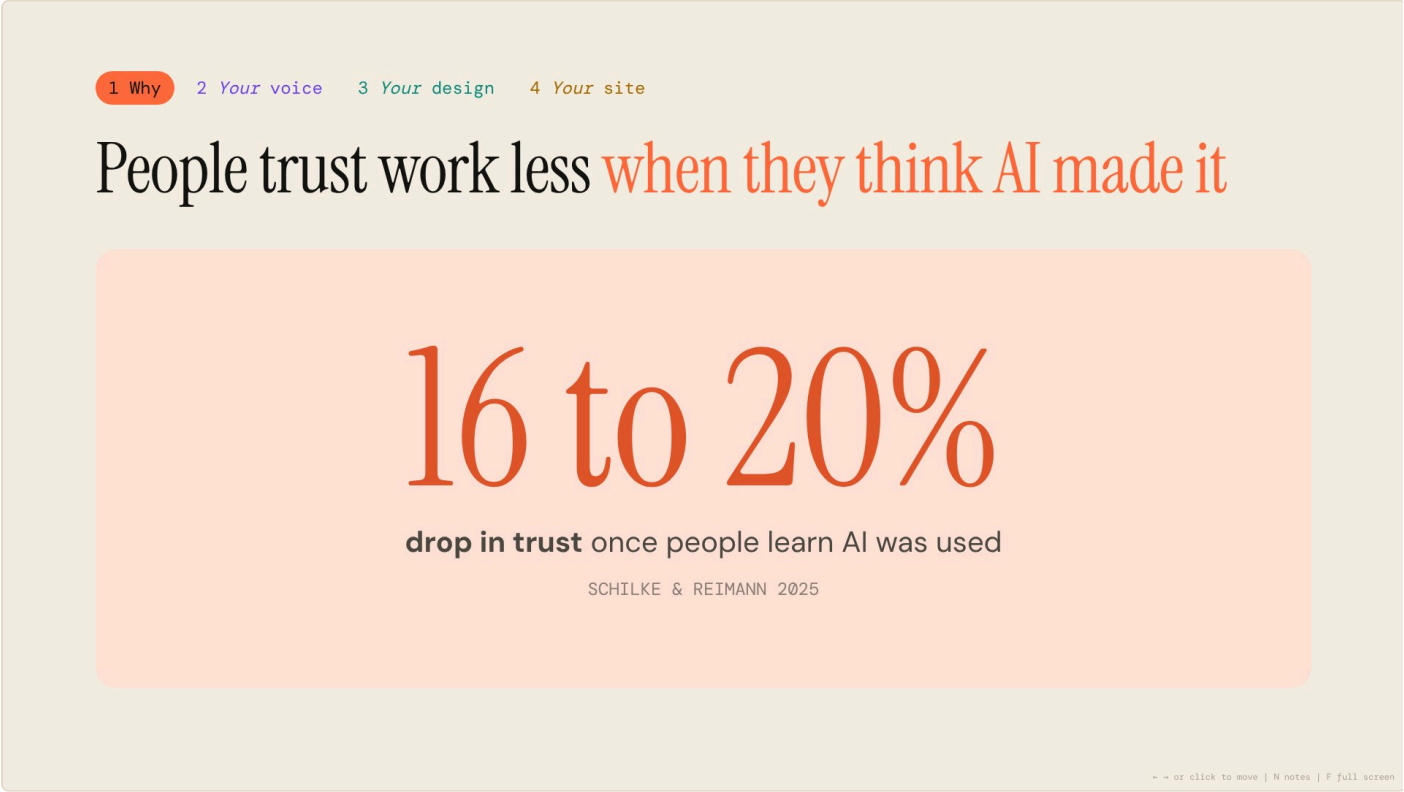
- 15 minutes of me, 50 of you building, 10 together at the end.
- My part covers why this matters, your voice, your design and your site.
- Skills are the method. AI that feels like you is the point.



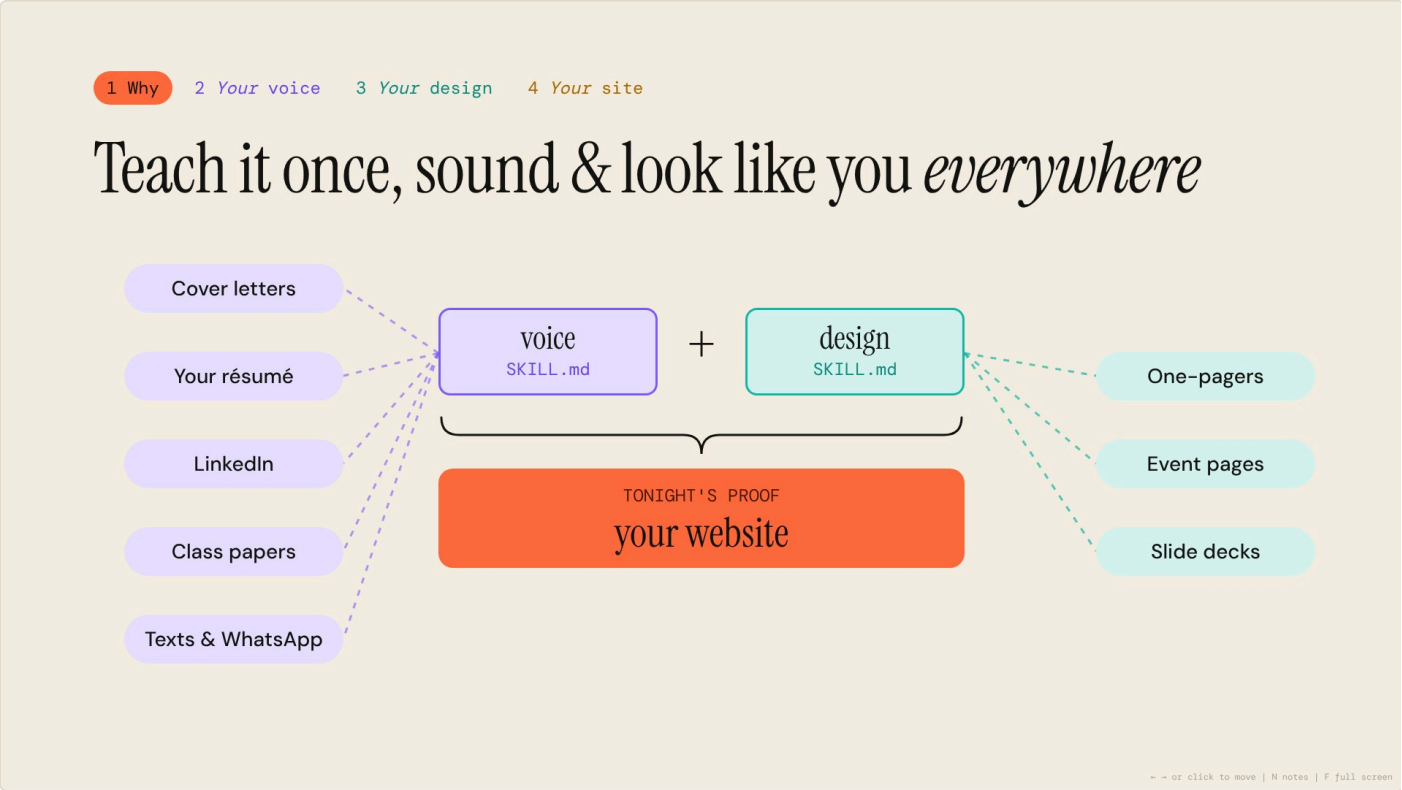
- Same prompt, two results.
- Left: a real no-skills output. Fine, but it could be anyone's.
- AI learned from everything, so its default lands in the middle.
- Right: same AI, same prompt, plus two small files. One for how I sound, one for how I look.



- Researchers played telephone with AI. One model describes an image, another redraws it from the description, 100 times over.
- 1,000 different starting images ended up as 12 kinds of picture: lighthouses, cities at night, cozy kitchens.
- Each description drops what's unusual, and each redraw fills the gap with the most common version.
- They called the result visual elevator music. Your bio and your site drift the same way unless you steer. (Hintze et al., Patterns, 2025)



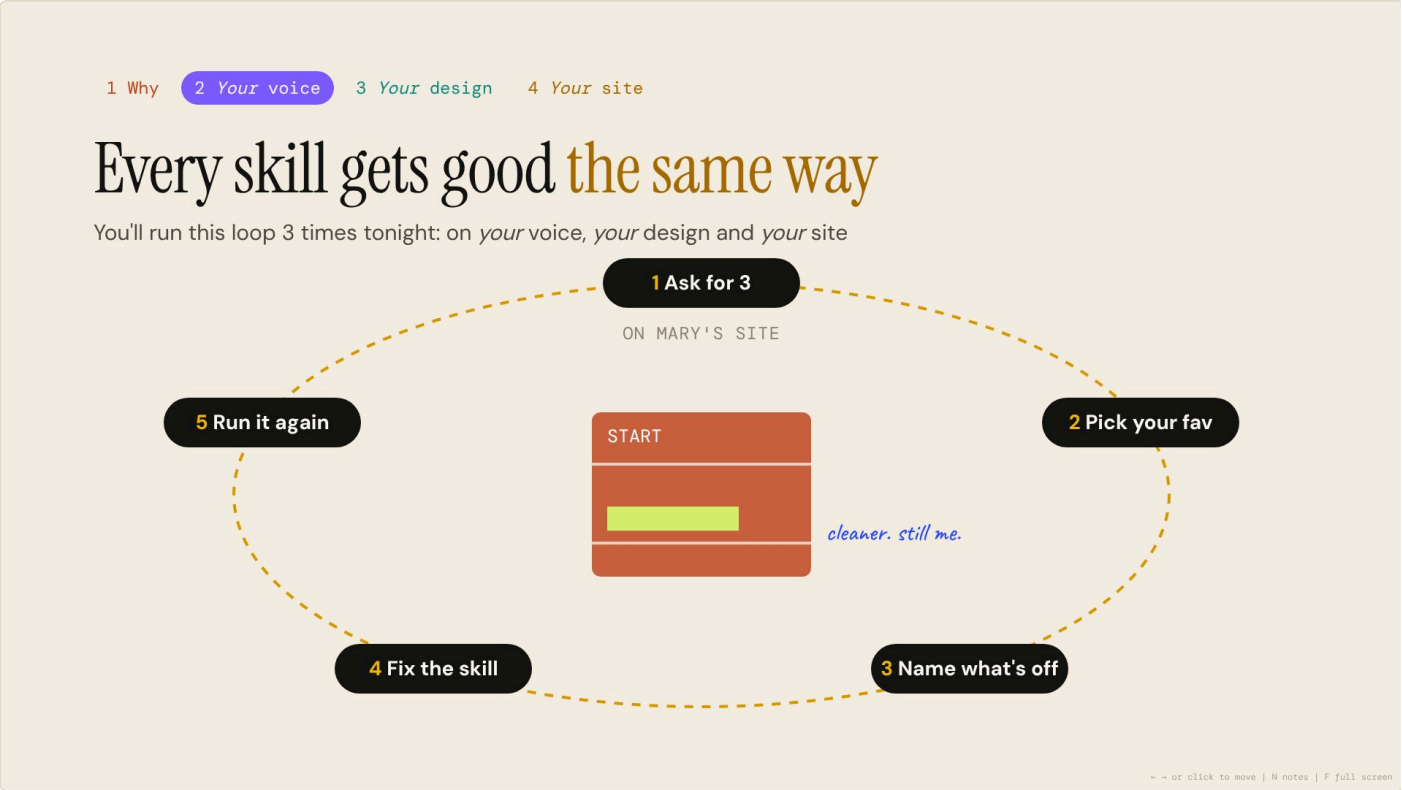
- 13 experiments, 5,000+ people. The work was identical. The only change was whether people were told AI helped.
- Trust dropped 16 to 20%, whether it was students judging a professor, investors judging a company or clients judging a designer. (Schilke and Reimann, OBHDP, 2025)
- Hiding AI isn't the answer. Make the output clearly yours.



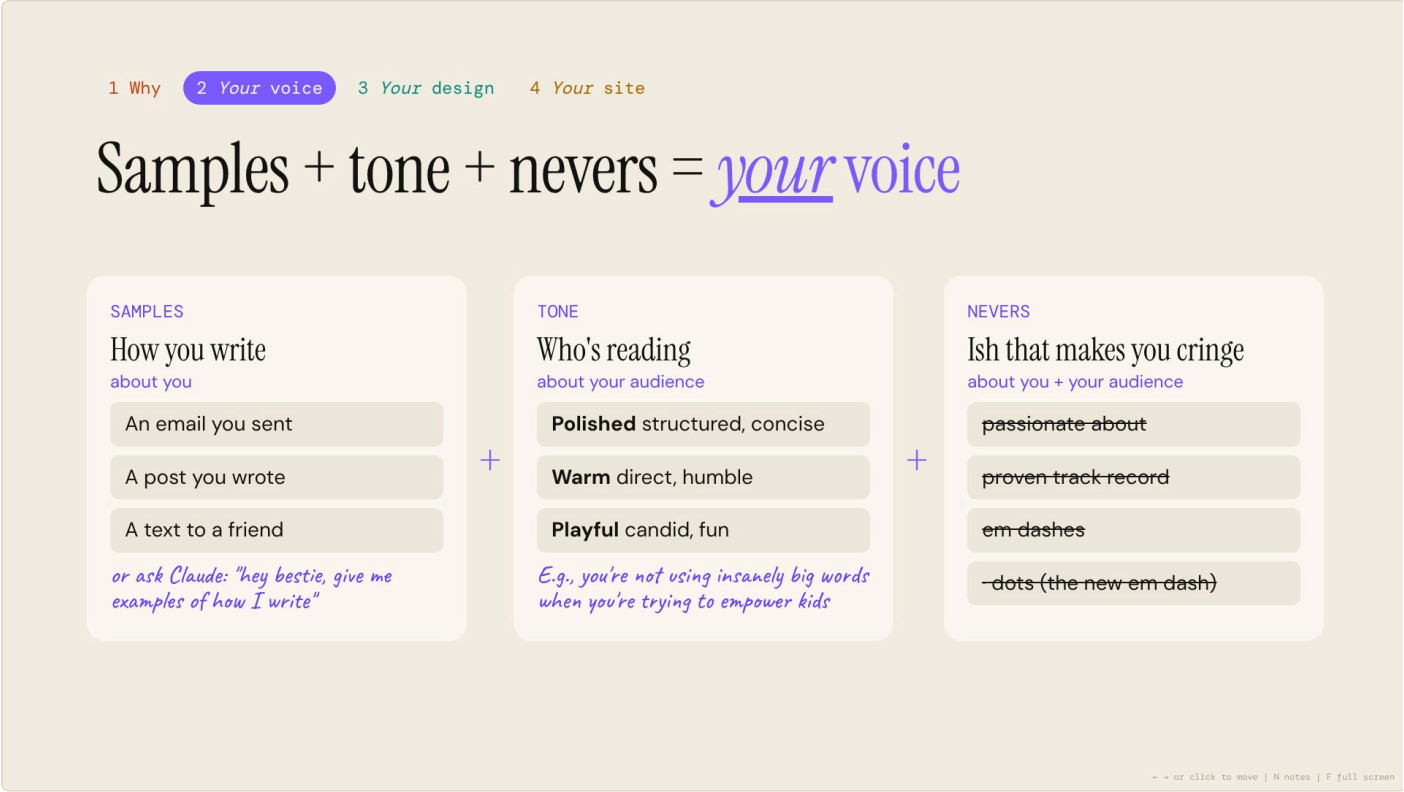
- Two small files: how you sound and how you look.
- Write them once and they carry into cover letters, LinkedIn, decks and one-pagers.
- Tonight's test is a personal website: voice plus design. It needs both words and visuals, so it tests both skills.



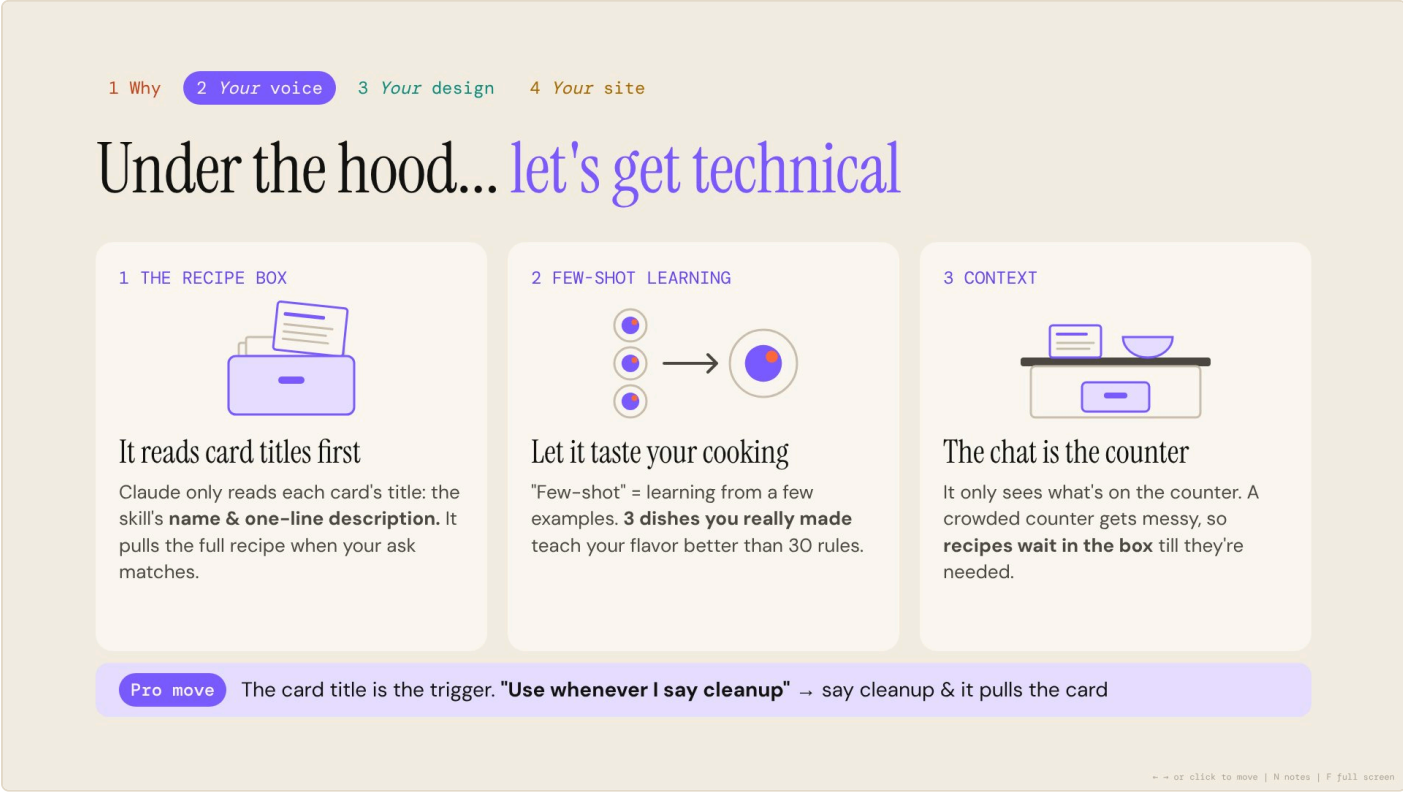
- A skill is a recipe card. Claude can cook, it just doesn't know your family's recipe.
- One voice skill for everything I write as me.
- One design skill per brand: Run Your City, AI@GSB, Out of Our Depth.
- Helpers on top: winning-writing (Glenn's class as a skill), humanizer, interviewer, class prep.
- All of them got good through the same loop.



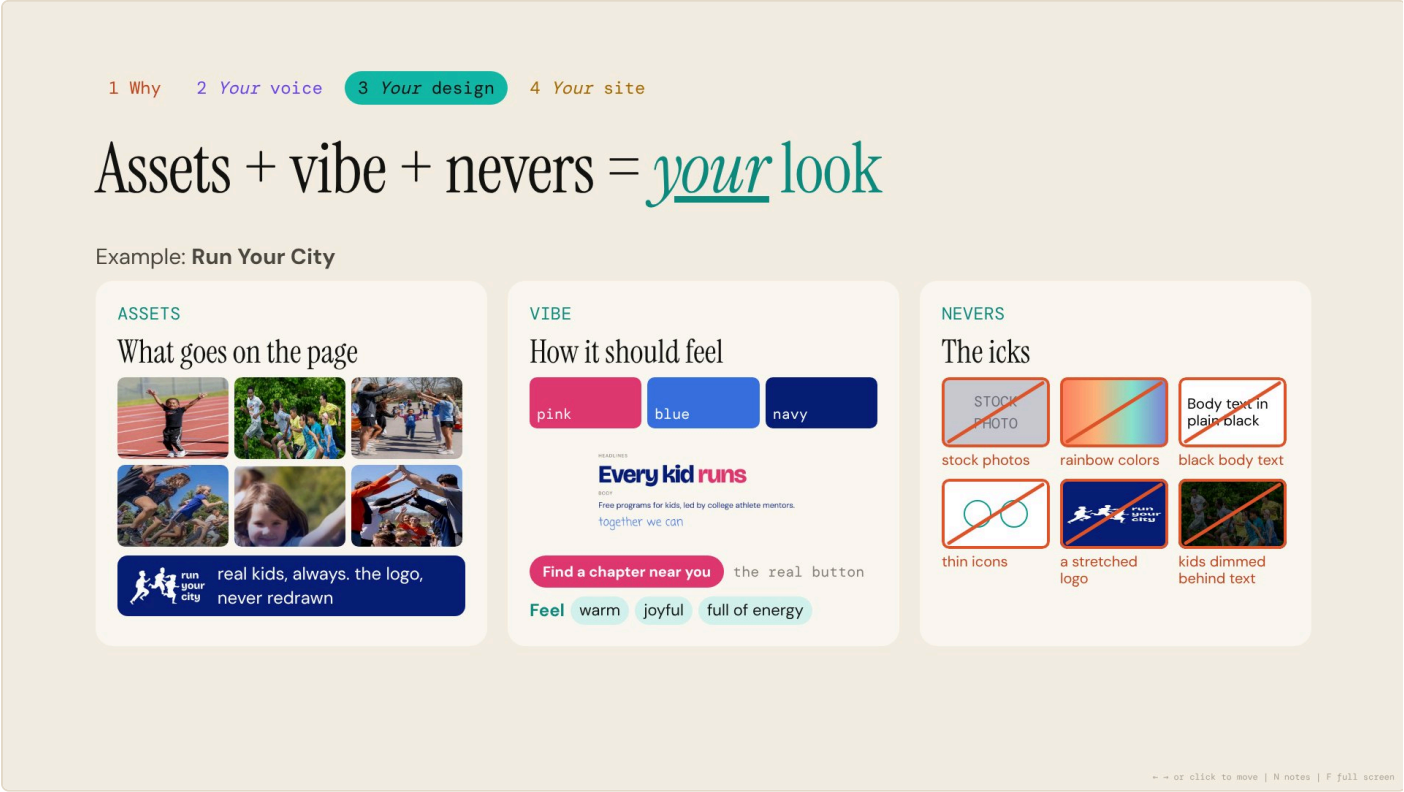
- Every skill improves the same way: ask for 3, pick your fav, name what's off, fix the skill, run it again.
- A real round from my site: I asked for three bolder directions and picked B, the track lanes.
- What was off: the start section was confusing and a thin line sat over the highlighter. Both went into my design skill.
- Run it again: cleaner, still me. You'll run this loop on your voice, your design and your site.
- A fix on the page lasts for that page. A fix in the skill carries into everything after.



- Samples are about you. Three real things you wrote teach more than a description of your style.
- Tone is about the reader. For Run Your City I write for kids, so I keep the words simple.
- Nevers are what you'd cringe at. Mine: "passionate about," em dashes, the little dots.
- Decide who reads your site before you build. One skill can hold more than one mode.



- Claude only reads a skill's name and description until your request matches it, so the title matters most.
- Few-shot: a few real examples teach your style better than a list of rules.
- The chat is the counter. Long chats get crowded and drift, so start fresh when it gets messy.
- Write the description like a trigger, e.g. "use whenever I say cleanup."



- Same three parts as voice: assets, vibe, nevers. A brand guide is basically a design skill.
- Run Your City assets: real kids in every photo, all from our own homepage and programs, and the logo as is.
- Vibe: pink, blue and navy, a bold headline font, warm and full of energy.
- Nevers: stock photos, rainbows, black body text, thin icons, a stretched logo, kids dimmed behind text.
- If you don't know your taste, give Claude two sites you love and ask what they share.

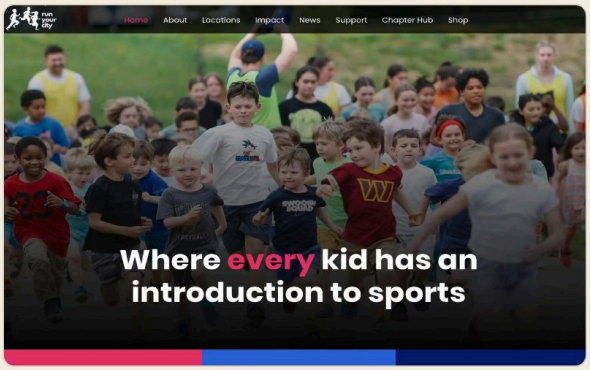
1 Why 2 *Your* voice 3 *Your* design 4 *Your* site

build, wince, write it down, repeat

Run Your City, one year apart

Same brand, same colors. What changed: a few lines in the design skill.

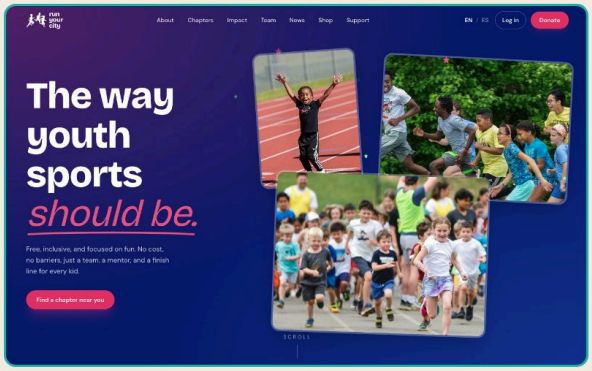
LAST YEAR



Right colors. Kids in the dark.

one dimmed photo, centered headline, color bars

TODAY



That's us. Live today.

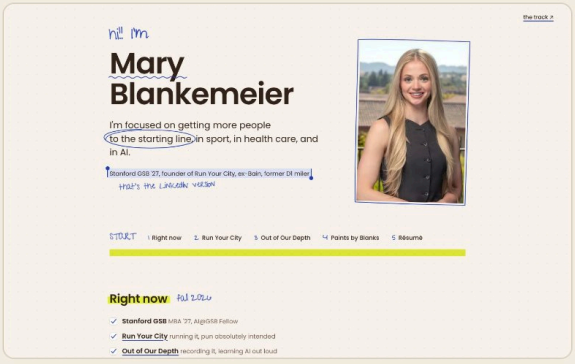
+ kids lead: real photos + bold font + never stock

← → or click to move | N notes | F full screen

- Two homepages, one year apart.
- Last year: right colors, but one dimmed photo with a centered headline on top. The kids sit in the background.
- Today: kids lead in bright real photos, a bold font, a pink handwritten accent. All of it is written in our design skill.
- We didn't redesign from scratch. We added a few lines to the skill each time something looked off.

1 Why 2 *Your* voice 3 *Your* design 4 *Your* site

Not to make it about me, but here's mine



mary-blankemeier.vercel.app

ASSETS	My headshot, resume & paintings
VIBE	Colors: Blue + yellow-green highlighter pulled from my headshot. Fonts: Poppins + handwriting
NEVERS	No emojis, tape on photos, big-number stats, dots, excessive spaces



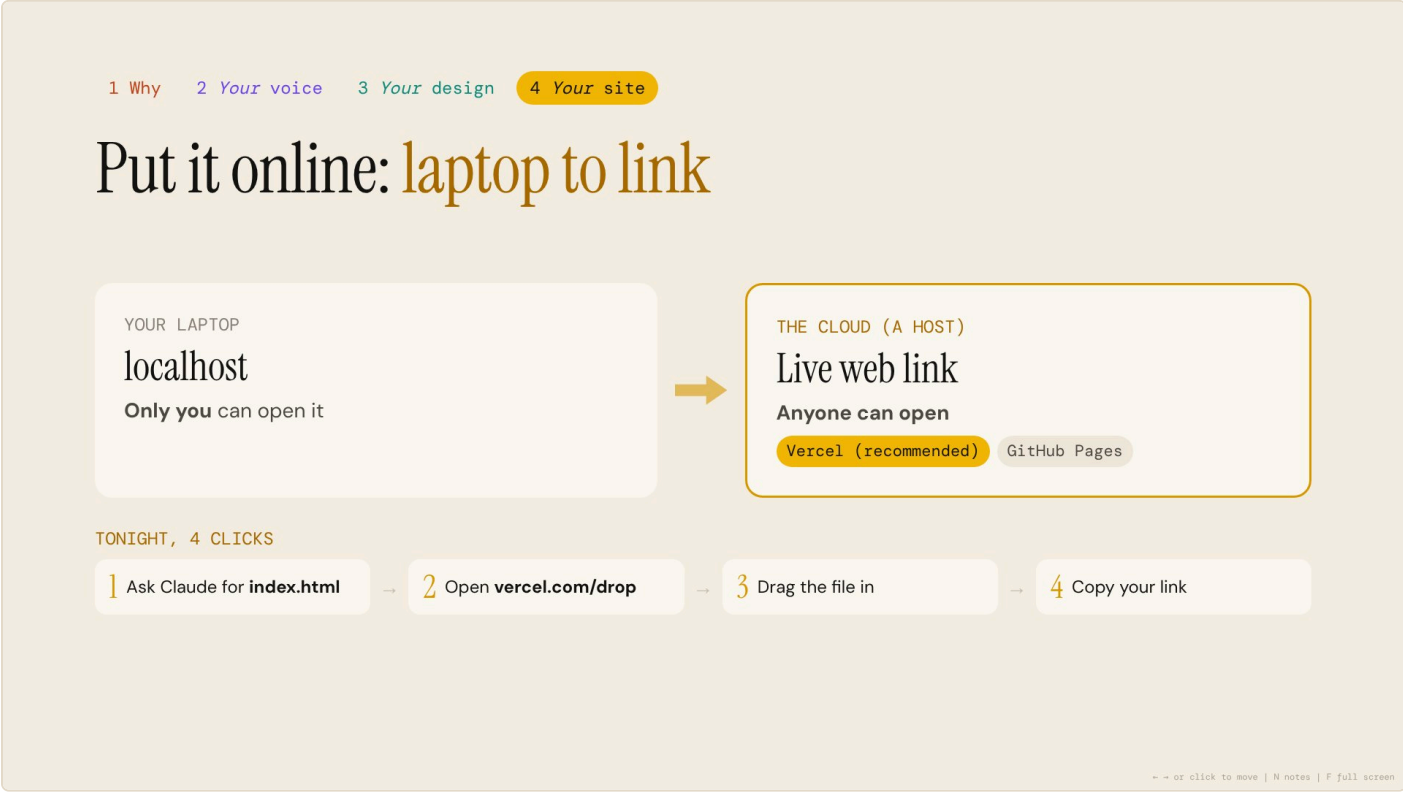
/explore: the 3D version, live

← → or click to move | N notes | F full screen

- My site uses the same formula.
- Assets: headshot, resume, paintings. Vibe: blue pen and a yellow-green highlighter from my headshot. Nevers: emojis, tape on photos, big-number stats, dots, extra spaces.
- I found my nevers by building, wincing and writing each one down.
- The 3D version lives at /explore. The tutorial's Go further section shows how to build one.

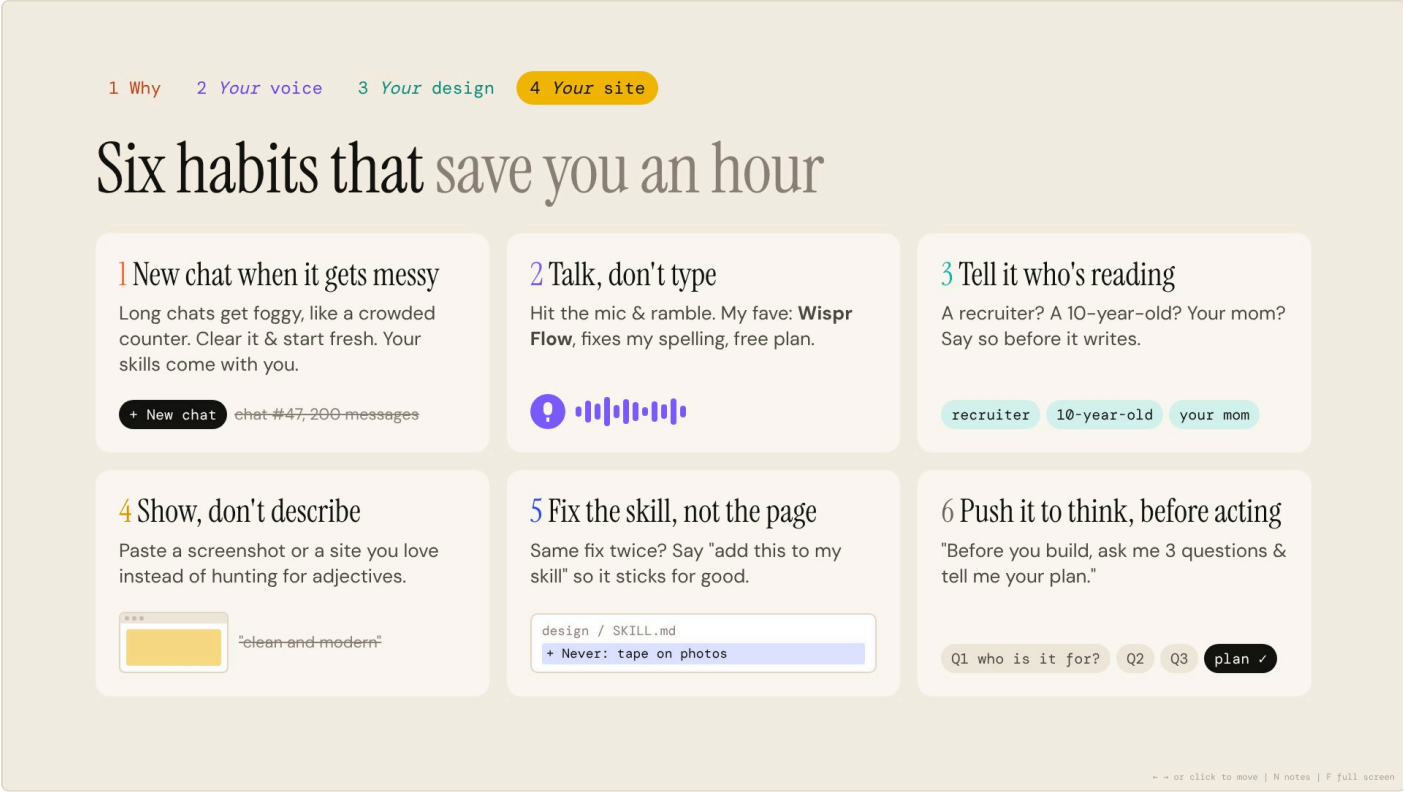


- You hand over two skills plus one line: "Make me a personal website so people feel like they know me." Add your goal.
- Ask for 3, pick one, say why. I picked the marked-up page because it felt most like me.
- Name what's off in plain words. Big-number stats felt corporate, tape on photos looked tacky. Claude swapped in plain bullets and a blue-pen outline.
- Put the fix in the skill. Both became nevers, so they never come back.

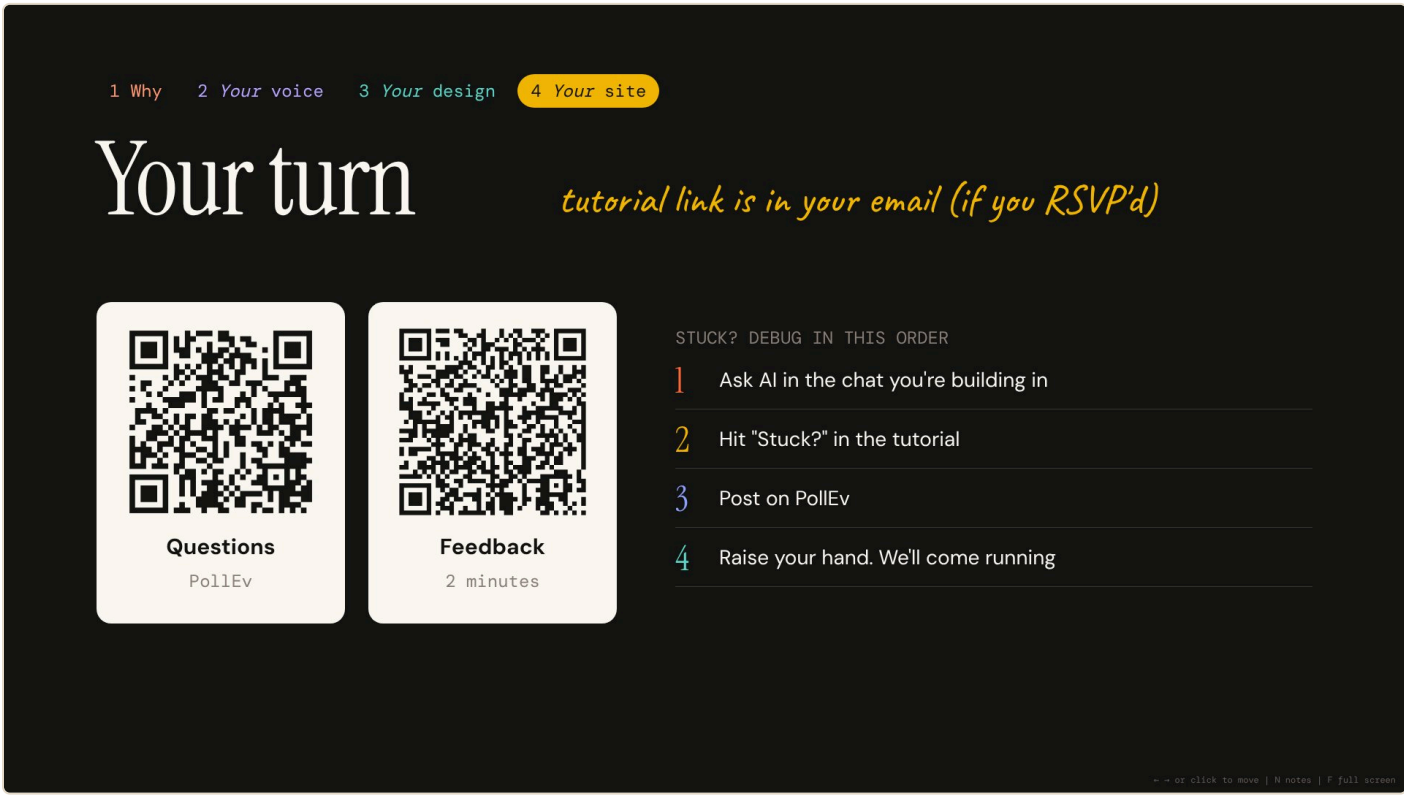


- On your laptop the site is localhost. Only you can open it.
- A host keeps it on an always-on computer in the cloud, so anyone with the link can see it.
- Tonight we use Vercel: free, drag one file. Netlify and GitHub Pages work the same way.
- Every click is in the tutorial, step 6.

19 TIPS



- Start a new chat when it gets messy. Skills carry over.
- Talk instead of type. Wispr Flow has a free plan.
- Tell it who's reading before it writes.
- Show a screenshot instead of describing.
- Fix the skill, not the page.
- Ask for 3 questions and a plan before it builds.



- The tutorial link is in your email if you RSVP'd: voice, design, build, host, step by step.
- If stuck: ask AI in your build chat, then the Stuck? button, then PollEv, then raise your hand.
- Feedback form before you leave. I'll share my site code and skill files.
- Finished early? Go further in the tutorial: 3D, day and night mode, your own domain.